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in DOS mode, an interface opens up and the image of the source is created on the destination partition or hard disk that you chose. After another restart, check your hard disk or partition for an image file (.gho extension).

You have successfully created an image of your hard disk!

Restoring Your Computer Using The Image

If you have saved the image and want to restore it, here's how to go about it:

Open Norton Ghost and click on 'Restore'. Click 'Next' in the Restore wizard. Now, the wizard asks you to select the source file—hard disk or partition where the image was originally created. Next choose the destination hard disk or partition that is to be restored. The wizard issues a warning that Windows will be rewritten. Check the box for confirmation and click next. In the next screen the wizard shows the devices and drivers that it cannot restore from the image. The Advanced settings allow you to choose external devices that are to be restored. Click 'Next' if you don't use any USB or FireWire devices. The wizard now shows the DOS interface that it will use during restoration. In the next screen the wizard displays the summary of restoration, and prompts you to save data and close all applications. Click 'OK'. Your Computer will reboot. The ghost creates a virtual partition and then reboots again. After rebooting, the restoration process takes place in the interface. The computer reboots again after the restoration process is complete. By restoring the ghost image you will be able to get your computer up and running in a matter of minutes!

On The Road To Recovery

Here's how you can go about recovering your data:

As soon as you realise your hard disk has crashed, shut down your machine to prevent any further damage to your disk. Then restart your machine, go to the BIOS and check if the hard disk is being detected. If your hard disk is not detected, you won't be able to recover data through any software. However, if the hard disk is

detected then there's a chance you can recover your data via software.

Plug in another hard disk to your computer so that the data you recover can be stored on it.

However, ensure that the second hard disk has more free space than the size of the data you need restored. If you wish, you can plug in a Zip drive as well, but make sure that the recovery software you're using supports such media.

Remember that though you might have another partition on the crashed hard disk, you can't recover data on the same hard disk. Hence, it becomes mandatory to plug in another storage medium in which data can be stored.

Make sure you have a bootable floppy disk. Insert the floppy disk and boot your machine from the floppy. After booting in DOS mode, insert the recovery software floppy diskette. We've taken the example of Easy Recovery software from Ontrack, which is considered to be one of the most effective. You can also use other software such as Stellar Phoenix Data Recovery Software, Final Data etc.

You will get an option to select the primary hard disk (the one that crashed) as the 'Recovery source' and the second hard disk as the 'Restore destination'. The software then analyses the data it has to recover from the crashed hard disk. It does this by trying to match it to the FAT Tables. The data that matches the FAT table is the data that is still visible to you, and the data that does not match the FAT table is generally the data you're trying to recover.

Once the utility finds raw data on the disk that equals a file, but finds no similar entry in the FAT Table, it marks the data as a recoverable file and adds it to the existing list of files it has. All the files that exist on the hard drive, whether in the FAT or detected by the software, are shown as recoverable files. Once this is done, you can choose what you want to recover, and it will be copied to the destination drive. The whole process might take hours to complete, depending on how much data has to be recovered.

